

I gave Claude the two .txt files containing the analyses from Gemini and OpenAI and had Claude compare them. I used the following short prompt:

„These are two AI-generated text analyses. Which one do you think is better, and why? Where do you see differences in content?“

Gemini vs. OpenAI: Quality Comparison

Overall verdict: Gemini is clearly better

Where Gemini is superior

1. Depth and precision of content Gemini works through the texts noticeably more carefully. In *Herrn Walthers letzte Fahrt*, for example, it mentions the crucial detail that Walther ultimately receives an imperial fief — a turning point that fundamentally motivates his inner transformation. OpenAI omits this entirely. In *Der falsche Kaiser*, Gemini explains the philosophical punchline (the Bürgermeister's secret question and the stranger's correct answer), while OpenAI vaguely describes a "disappearance into the light."

2. Spatial analysis Gemini consistently breaks down the representation of space into three levels — **topographical**, **atmospheric**, and **emotional** — naming specific streets, buildings, and squares (e.g. Herzogengrube, Sandstraße, Beckergrube). OpenAI tends to stay generic here, recycling phrases like "vibrant city" or "rich cultural heritage" across multiple stories.

3. Thematic coherence Gemini identifies and articulates an overarching thread running through the collection: the tension between Lübeck's Hanseatic-mercantile pragmatism on one side, and art, emotion, and the irrational on the other. OpenAI largely lacks this framing — the batches feel placed side by side rather than woven together.

4. Literary quality of analysis Observations like "art is the distance in the near" (from *Das Ochsenwunder*) or the note that Erna's ventriloquism loses its subversive power through commercialization (*Spuk im Tünnenhagen*) show genuine engagement with the texts. OpenAI operates at a noticeably more abstract and formulaic level.

Where OpenAI falls short

Language inconsistency: OpenAI switches between German and English without any apparent logic (Batch 2 in German, Batch 1 in English), which feels uncoordinated.

Batch structure without synthesis: The analyses are delivered as self-contained blocks with no connecting tissue. Each batch essentially restarts, and cross-references between stories are absent.

Content inaccuracies: Some summaries are vague or internally contradictory — for instance, in *Herr Hinrich Kastorp*, the plan for a choir chapel is described as both a success and as somehow triggering the mayor's death, which comes across as confused.

What both do well

Both analyses cover the same stories and follow the same structure (plot, spatial representation, themes/motifs). Both correctly identify core themes such as art vs. commerce, Lübeck's civic identity, and the role of historical legend.

Bottom line: Gemini reads like a genuine literary analysis with real textual understanding. OpenAI reads like a competent template that fills in the right boxes but rarely goes beneath the surface.